

Acer Iconica Tab A501

AT&T would carry the Acer Iconica Tab A501, it has Android Honeycomb with 4G support.

A 100 million for Samsung

Samsung is rejoicing over the fact that its Apps store has crossed a hundred million downloads

SECURITY THREATS

you should know about

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Imagine you're spending a lazy Sunday afternoon at home just chilling, updating your blog with photos of the new bike you just bought, chatting on Facebook at the same time. Suddenly, you get a call from your friend inviting you out for dinner. You start to get ready and tweet about the plan before you leave your house. On your way, you update your status on Foursquare expecting to gather a few more friends.

After a fun filled evening, you return home to find that your house has been broken into. You've been robbed of all your precious belongings. Think some notorious thief is at large? That might be the case, only thing is that this is a more sophisticated kind of thief. He didn't need to anticipate your every move or watch you too closely either. You did all the hard work for him, updating him about everything you're up to. All he had to do was follow.

It may seem a little far fetched today, but isn't that where we're headed? Thanks to technology, it's becoming easier for the nefarious to track our every move. According to the "Norton Cybercrime Report: The Human Impact 2010", 76 per cent of internet users in India have fallen victim to a cyber crime. Of course this includes getting a virus at some point in your life also as a "cyber crime", but social engineering attacks are on the rise.

We decided that it was time to look at the top pitfalls you will face going forth, and try and figure out how to avoid them.

Social media scourges

Everyone you know is using social media, and according to Comscore,

India is the eighth largest social networking market in the world.

With increasing integration on our hand-held devices, services such as geo-tagging and geo-location are on rise. Being careless about your location status makes you vulnerable to attacks all the more, as cyber crooks know where and when you're travelling. You leave a wealth of information behind for everyone to see.

Geolocation: Never use geo-location services from your home, this is as good as putting posters around the city declaring your address, follow same practice for your office.

Pattern recognition: If you happen to go to the same coffee shop every Friday evening, it's not difficult to decipher it. Don't update this information each time you visit the place.

Phishing: Watch out for suspicious page invites on Facebook even from trusted sources such as your friends. These are fake log-in pages which seek your permission by asking

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your credentials. Once they gain access to your page they then exploit information like your pictures and videos which you've uploaded.

Facebook engineering: It's a well known fact that Facebook privacy setting are loose. Don't reveal too much personal information, avoid posting pictures that compromise your security, avoid posting your address and mobile number.

Passwords: Many people use "Your pet's name" or something similar as their security question. Thanks to social media, such personal details are very easily available.

Twitter botnets: Similar to the command-and-control IRC botnets, hackers are now using Twitter to spread specific types of malicious malware on a PC which follows these bots on Twitter. Once these bots are on your system they can be commanded to wipe or steal your data. Make sure the people you follow are not bots, and revoke access to all unused apps on your account, as they could share your feeds with third party applications you no longer use.

Cellphone curses

Malware infecting smartphones has increased by 33 per cent in the last year alone. Symbian was the most loved platform for hackers to attack, but that was only until now. With the advent of smartphones and availability of millions of apps, operating systems such as Android will see the most number of attacks this year. Recently Google was forced to pull down 50 apps from Android market as close to 200,000 users downloaded the 'DroidDream' app.

Gaurav Kanwal, Country Sales Manager Symantec says, "As we go beyond the PC to experience the benefits of the internet, we need to step ahead of cybercriminals in these new environments."

Watch that app: Only download apps which are useful and essential to you. Getting just about every other free app you see online, just to try it out is not very safe. Also, when installing an app, read the permissions it's asking for, and if you're uncomfortable granting it those privileges, don't! Get a free antivirus like Lookout Mobile Security to ensure that unwanted malware doesn't creep into your phone, keep in mind that the data and contacts on your phone are more important than the data on your PC. To know more on how you can secure your Android handset read our article on page 28.

Wi-Fi hotspots: Just because you see an open Wi-Fi network, doesn't mean